

FAMILY MATH

Count On from a Visible Part

Dear Family,

Your student is practicing the addition strategy of counting on from a known part to find the total. For example, the dice in the images show two parts, 5 and 2. Rather than counting all the dots, they start with a part they know and count on from that number to find the total. As they count on, they may point to the dots or use their fingers to keep track of the counts. Starting with the larger part, such as 5, is more efficient, but your student discovers that counting on from either part results in the same total. Your student learns that the number we are trying to figure out is called the unknown, and that when both parts are the same number, they are called doubles.

Key Terms

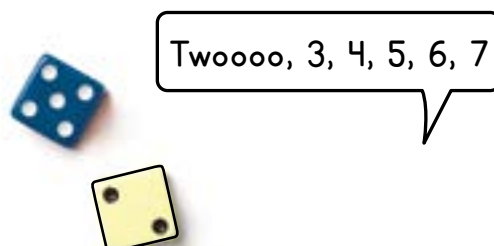
doubles

unknown



5 dots are on one die.
Count on 2 more dots.

$$5 + 2 = 7$$



2 dots are on one die.
Count on 5 more dots.

$$2 + 5 = 7$$

At-Home Activities

Let's Count On

Gather a set of 10 objects such as coins, marbles, or cups. Arrange the objects into two groups with an easily countable pattern, like dots on dice or dominoes. Ask your student to find the total by counting on by asking these questions. After your student has counted, note that the total stays the same no matter which group they started with.

- “How many objects are in this group?”
- “Can you count on from that number to find the total of both groups?”
- “What would change if you started counting with the other group?”

Find Real-World Totals

Look for opportunities to practice the count on strategy with your student, such as those in the following examples. Encourage your student to count on by using their fingers to keep track of the amount they add on.

- “This new box of granola bars holds 10 bars. The open box in our cabinet still has some bars in it. Can you count on from 10 to find how many bars we have in all?”
- “There are 5 cars in this parking lot and 3 empty spaces. Can you count on from 5 to find the total number of parking spaces in the parking lot?”